

Influence, contributions and achievements

Alexander is remembered as one of the greatest generals of all time. His campaign to conquer the Persian Empire lasted eleven years from 334BC to his death in June 323BC.

Alexander's army crossed 20 000 kilometres of difficult terrain, fought in four major battles, countless minor ones and conducted a number of difficult sieges, all successfully.

As well as conquering the Persian Empire, Alexander established Greek and Macedonian control over the Near East through his ability as an administrator. He spread Greek, or Hellenistic, culture across the Near East by the founding of cities; and encouraged trade and the exchange of ideas in science, geography, medicine and art between the Greeks and the east.

The Macedonian army

Philip created a highly experienced and efficient army. This army dominated the Balkans and was now, in the hands of Alexander, to conquer the armies of the east with its superior weaponry, flexibility and discipline. The army contained three distinct elements: the infantry, the cavalry and a corps of siege engineers.

pezetairos
literally 'foot
companion' of
the king; a pike
man

The pezetairoi

The main type of infantryman used in the Macedonian army was the peze-

Alexander's journey through the Persian Empire

